

Getting Together

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Countries Want Independence, Nations Want Liberation, People Want Revolution

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April 29 mass rally and march gave support to Stearns miners strike (Getting Together photo)

STEARNS STRIKE- 23 MONTHS AND STILL FIGHTING

Stearns, Ky — The strike of over 140 coal miners at the Justus Mine is almost two years old — and still going strong. The striking miners remain united and unshaken in their struggle to join the United Mine Workers of America (UMWA), despite increasing attempts by the Blue Diamond Coal Company to smash the strike.

In late May, Blue Diamond increased the number of scabs to 60. On June 1, they staged a so-called "election" in which the scabs voted in a scab-union that the company concocted, the "Justus Mine Association Union." Blue Diamond now claims that the mine is a union mine, and that the UMWA no longer represents the workers. In this way, the company hopes to give the impression that the strike is "settled."

But this latest tactic can't stop the Stearns miners. They have been waging a fierce and often violent battle with Blue Diamond since 1976, when they voted to join the UMWA. Blue Diamond has stubbornly refused to negotiate a contract with a clause providing for a union safety committee in the mine. The miners walked out in July 1976, and coal production has been shut down ever since.

In the past two months, the struggle has escalated with increased harassment and violent attacks on the miners by the company and the state. The company started to bring in more scabs in April, mainly to intimidate the strikers. Many of the scabs do not even know how to mine coal, so production has remained at a standstill. **continued on p. 5**

China's speech supports non-aligned countries

U.N. ARMS TALKS TARGET SUPERPOWERS

A special United Nations conference on disarmament opened in New York on May 23, attended by 149 countries. The conference was called at the urging of the non-aligned countries — countries independent of the two imperialist superpowers — to express their growing dissatisfaction at the intensifying arms race between the U.S. and the Soviet Union.

The conference is the largest of its kind in decades and comes at a time when the clouds of world war are darkening on the horizon. The contention of the two superpowers for world domination is rapidly increasing, with the Soviet Union being the more aggressive, and the more dangerous source of war.

In the five-week session, delegates will first hear the views of the participants on how to achieve disarmament, and then will attempt to draft a declaration and a program of action to guide U.N. disarmament negotiations.

The opening speech was delivered by Lazar Mosjov of Yugoslavia, President of the General Assembly, who pinpointed the U.S. and the Soviet Union as the "chief actors" in the arms race, a result of their single minded rivalry for world domination. In speech after speech, delegates from around the world sounded this same theme, and demanded that the two superpowers start dismantling their huge military arsenals.

China's speech

China's representative to the conference, Foreign Minister Huang Hua, spoke on May 29. His comprehensive speech reflected the concerns of many third world and second world countries. Reviewing the dismal history of past disarmament conferences, Huang Hua stated, "Lack of sincere desire on the part of the superpowers is the key reason why there has been no progress in disarmament over such a long period. The superpowers camouflage their arms expansion with rhetoric about disarmament. We should not give credence to their fine-sounding words, but should call on them to take practical measures of disarmament."

"The people of the world want genuine and not sham disarmament. The superpowers, however, cook up all sorts of disarmament hoaxes to lull the people of the world, to tie the hands of other countries, and by these each of them wants to restrain the other party."

Hitting at the distortions being pushed by the superpowers to cover their feverish arms buildup, China stated, "The two superpowers, the Soviet Union and the United States, are deliberately confusing the issue by advocating disarmament by all. Their armaments already far exceed their defense needs and are being used as tools of aggression and expansion and tools in the struggle for hegemony."

"The Soviet propaganda machine has even slandered the third world as being the 'source of the arms race' and called

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Learn from the concentration camp experience of Japanese in the U.S.

300 make pilgrimage to Tule Lake



Participants in the Tule Lake Pilgrimage join together for group pictures (Getting Together photo)

Tule Lake, CA — From Washington, Oregon and from as far south as San Diego, California, over 300 people came to Tule Lake for a pilgrimage on the weekend of June 3-4. This was the first Tule Lake Pilgrimage in 3 years, and one of the largest periodic mass pilgrimages to the various sites of the World War II U.S. concentration camps. These camps imprisoned 112,000 Japanese in the U.S. from 1942-1946.

Japanese of all generations joined the Tule Lake Pilgrimage, as well as newer immigrants who share many of the same problems as part of the Japanese

national minority in the U.S. People of all nationalities also came to retrace and learn from the concentration experience of Japanese in the U.S.

The day-long activities were dedicated to all the Japanese who were imprisoned in the camps.

The Tule Lake Committee opened the morning program. Solidarity messages from the Japanese American Citizens League (JACL) and the Manzanar Committee, which sponsored a pilgrimage to the Manzanar concentration camp site on April 22-23, were given. The struggle of the northern California Native Americans

was presented by a speaker from the Legitimate Pit River Tribal Council.

A skit portrayed a Japanese family's experience from the day the Japanese militarists bombed Pearl Harbor on December 7, 1941, to the time of their imprisonment in the concentration camps. It brought tears to the eyes of many Issei and Nisei (first and second generation Japanese in the U.S.). One woman later commented that she had forgotten her own reaction to the camps in 1942. But through the skit, her anger and fighting spirit broke through.

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1000's JOIN ANTI-BAKKE WEEK OF STRUGGLE

"We are in the process of rekindling the flames of rebellion that lit cities across this country in the 1960's. People of all nationalities — students, workers, minority communities and women — are joining together not only to smash the Bakke Decision but to break the chains of national oppression."

These words by an Anti Bakke Decision Coalition speaker echoed the militant opposition to the Bakke Decision displayed by masses of people from May 6-13 in the National Week of Struggle/Semana de Lucha.

This creative and active week of anti-Bakke activities from coast to coast educated and organized thousands of people around the main slogans: Smash the Bakke Decision, End National Oppression, Fight for the Full Equality of Women, and Defend and Expand Affirmative Action in Education and on the Job. These actions culminated the National Spring Offensive to prepare massive response to the U.S. Supreme Court decision, anticipated sometime this spring.

Highlighting the week were regional demonstrations held in San Francisco,

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